Ben Brook

GAME & LEVEL DESIGNER

CONTACT

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Los Angeles · open to remote

DESIGN

- Level & mission design
- Quest & narrative design
- Combat encounters & enemy design
- Pacing & spatial flow
- Systemic mechanics
- VR interaction & haptics
- Live ops

TECHNICAL

- Unreal Engine 5 & 4
- Blueprint visual scripting
- AI behavior trees & navigation
- World Partition & streaming
- Profiling & optimization

TOOLS

Perforce · Jira · Confluence
Miro · Figma · Illustrator
Maya · 3ds Max

EDUCATION

BFA, Interactive Design & Game Development
Savannah College of Art and Design · 2017–2020

COMMUNITY

Mentor, Always Supporting the Games Community (ASGC)

Game and level designer working across AAA, live ops and VR since 2022. I turn creative direction into missions, spaces and systems, and prototype them myself in Blueprints. Shipped VR titles at Skydance Games; now designing content for MapleStory Classic World at Nexon.

EXPERIENCE

Game Designer
2026 – PRESENT

Nexon America · MapleStory Classic World

- Owned the Forgotten Hollow region end to end after its initial concept: 26 maps, 25 quests and questlines, NPCs, narrative, monster placement and theming for levels 39–60. Launches November 18, 2026.
- Designed the Caretaker's Ledger, a six-part questline live today that tours Victoria Island and introduces the NPC who opens Forgotten Hollow.
- Design core systems and help keep a live MMORPG stable for a global audience.

Level Designer
AUG 2024 – AUG 2025

Cloud Chamber (2K) · BioShock 4 (unannounced)

- Owned core narrative missions on the Living World strike team, from paper design and blockout through Alpha in Unreal Engine 5.
- Defined critical-path pacing, objectives, AI combat encounters and layouts in line with the creative director's vision.
- Scripted bespoke gameplay moments and interaction chains in Blueprints, reducing engineering overhead.
- Led Art, Audio and Narrative partners through data-informed iteration and late-stage polish.

Gameplay / Level Designer
MAR 2023 – AUG 2024

Skydance Games · Skydance's Behemoth (PS VR2, Quest, PC VR) · Project Lonestar

- Concepted Behemoth's final area, the setting for the climactic fight that closes the campaign.
- Designed the opening chapter's castle hub: a grand entryway onto a courtyard built around a central arch landmark, connecting to two further areas.
- Built VR melee combat spaces and physics-based interactions in Unreal Engine 5.
- Took the hub of an unannounced Walking Dead VR title (courthouse, police station and connecting tunnel) from paper maps to a playable UE5 vertical slice.

Game / Level Designer
JAN 2022 – MAR 2023

Skydance Games · The Walking Dead: Saints & Sinners – Chapter 2: Retribution

- Designed, concepted, tested and implemented every new weapon and attachment (chainsaw, sawed-off shotgun, SMG, grenade launcher, silencers, laser sights) with art, audio and animation; rebalanced the assault rifle and 9mm pistol.
- Designed the Eradicator and Tower Grenadier enemies from spec through Blueprint implementation and playtest tuning.
- Designed and tuned every chainsaw haptic curve across PS VR2, Quest and PC VR.
- Specced Night Mode's dead-body loot system and rebuilt Tower Mission 2 around Exile Orders.
- Designed and implemented all Exile camps across the game's New Orleans maps.

Lead Gameplay Designer
2020 – 2021

SCAD Games Studio · Zoélie

- Owned core mechanics, the 3Cs and puzzle design on a 39-person team for a combat-free 3D puzzle platformer.
- Won Best Gameplay, 1st place, at the 2021 Intel University Games Showcase.

GAME JAMS

Wild Magic · GMTK 2020, top 19% of 5,244 entries · **Hell, My Name Is Buba** · Epic MegaJam 2021 · **Beepo & Pogo** · GMTK 2021